

Knowledge and Power

1800-1914

In the 19th century, Western nations were gripped by a desire for knowledge and exploration. The period saw a number of women traversing the globe and educating themselves, breaking free of societies that sought to confine them to a domestic role. Furthermore, the Industrial Revolution required immense labor mobilization, and more women entered the waged workforce. The revolutionary spirit of the preceding era persisted: women engaged with change but also fought it when it harmed them, which change often did. Women were frequently exploited in the workplace and the growth of the European empires set back women's rights in many colonized countries.